

Client Dashboard Guide

Everything you need to know about using your project portal

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1. Getting Started

Your Client Dashboard is a secure, web-based portal where you can review design proofs, track project progress, communicate directly with the Great Creation Studios team, and access all your project documents. It is accessible from any modern web browser on desktop, tablet, or mobile.

Best Experience: The dashboard is designed for landscape orientation. For the best experience, use a desktop or laptop, or turn your device to landscape mode. Portrait orientation on smaller screens may not display all features correctly.

Logging In

You will receive login credentials (an email address and access code) from Great Creation Studios when your account is created. To log in:

- 1 Navigate to your project URL provided by Great Creation Studios.
- 2 Enter your email address and access code.
- 3 You will be taken directly to your dashboard.

Tip: Keep your access credentials secure. Do not share them with anyone who is not authorized to view your project. If you suspect unauthorized access, notify Great Creation Studios immediately through the Communication tab.

Dashboard Layout

Your dashboard has four main tabs across the top:

- **Proofs** — View and annotate design deliverables
- **Reports** — See project health, budget, hours, and timeline
- **Comm** — Send and receive messages with the Great Creation Studios team
- **Resource** — Access invoices, contracts, legal documents, and other files

2. Proofs — Review & Annotate Designs

The Proofs tab is where you review design work and provide feedback. This is the primary tool for communicating exactly what you like, what needs changing, and where.

Viewing Proofs

Select a proof from the file sidebar on the left. The design will load in the main viewer area. Use the zoom controls (**+** and **-**) to zoom in and out for detail work.

Annotation Tools

The toolbar above the proof viewer provides four tools. Clicking any tool activates it and opens the Annotations and Comments panel on the right side of the viewer:

- **Select** — Click on existing annotations to view, move, or delete them
- **Draw** — Freehand draw directly on the proof to circle areas, underline text, or sketch changes
- **Measure** — Click two points to measure distances on the proof. The endpoints can be dragged to adjust.
- **Annotate** — Click anywhere on the proof to place a text note at that exact location

Tip: If you don't see the Annotations and Comments panel, click any annotation tool in the toolbar to open it.

Colours

Choose from 11 colours in the toolbar to organize your feedback visually. For example, you might use red for critical changes, green for approvals, and copper for general notes.

Comments

The right panel shows two sections: **Annotations** (a list of all drawn/placed annotations) and **Comments** (a conversation thread specific to the current proof). Use comments for longer discussions about the proof.

Note: Each proof has its own separate set of annotations and comments. Switching between proofs loads the feedback for that specific version. Your annotations are saved automatically.

Annotation Etiquette

- Be specific — place annotations exactly where the change is needed
- Be clear — describe what you want changed, not just what you don't like
- Consolidate — submit all feedback for one round together rather than one note at a time
- You can only move or delete your own annotations

3. Reports — Track Project Progress

The Reports tab gives you a real-time view of your project's status. All data is updated by the Great Creation Studios team as the project progresses.

Project Metrics

- **Project Health** — An overall percentage indicating how the project is tracking. 100% means everything is on schedule and on spec.
- **Budget** — Shows the amount spent versus the total budget in Canadian dollars (CAD).
- **Hours** — Hours worked versus total estimated hours for the project.

Timeline

A list of project milestones with dates and completion status. Completed milestones are marked with a filled indicator. This gives you a clear picture of what has been done

and what is coming next.

Recent Activities

A log of recent project actions, such as proof uploads, revision rounds, approvals, and deliveries.

4. Communication — Message the Team

The Comm tab is your direct line to the Great Creation Studios team. All messages are logged as part of the project record.

Sending Messages

- 1 Click the Comm tab to open the messaging view.
- 2 Type your message in the input field at the bottom.
- 3 Press Enter or click the send button (➤) to send.

Attachments

Click the paperclip icon () to attach files to your message. Supported formats include images, PDFs, and text documents up to 20MB.

Emojis

Click the smiley face icon to open the emoji picker and add emojis to your messages.

System Messages

Messages with a lavender background are system messages — automated notifications about project events, status changes, or triggered responses. These are generated by the platform, not by a person.

Pinned Messages

Important messages may be pinned by the Great Creation Studios team. Pinned messages appear highlighted at the top of the chat so you can easily find key information.

Important: Do not share sensitive personal information (government IDs, banking details) through the messaging system. Contact Great Creation Studios directly for sensitive matters.

5. Resources — Access Your Documents

The Resource tab provides access to all project-related documents organized into categories:

Invoices

View and download invoices for your project. Invoices show the amount, status (paid/pending), and date. All amounts are in Canadian dollars (CAD).

Contracts

Access your service agreements and project terms. Standard contracts that apply to all clients are marked with a **Standard** tag. Any client-specific agreements will appear alongside them.

Legal

Review the legal documents that govern our working relationship, including:

- **Terms of Service** — The master agreement covering all services
- **Privacy Policy** — How your data is handled (PIPEDA compliant)
- **Confidentiality Policy** — Mutual confidentiality obligations
- **Acceptable Use Policy** — Rules for using the portal

Resources

Additional project resources, guides, and reference materials provided by Great Creation Studios.

Note: Documents marked **Standard** are shared terms that apply to all clients. Documents marked **Client** are specific to your project.

Have a question? See the **Frequently Asked Questions** document in Resources, or send a message through the Communication tab.